

STAX Lab Follow-Up Email

Follow-up on the 2022 school lunch grant scoring change

From: The Hon. Dr. Sir Jensen Ahokovi, PhD, MA, BA. <jensen@stax.example>
To: STAX Predoc Team <predocs@stax.example>
Date: Thursday, March 14, 2024 at 3:42 PM

Hi team,

Thanks for putting together the school-year panel and the notes. This is very helpful, and I think it may be enough for a first analysis pass.

One more thing: I confirmed that the state changed the modernization grant scoring in 2022. After the change, applications tied to scratch-cooking equipment, cold storage, and healthier serving-line infrastructure received a clearer priority. That gives us a real policy break to work with.

If the change had bite, I would expect to see something like more schools receiving grants, larger grant amounts, or improvements in lunch participation and healthy-meal scores after 2022. It may also matter whether schools had already shown meal-program leadership before the scoring change.

Could you take a first pass at whether the panel shows anything along those lines? Please use your judgment about the exact comparisons. Pre/post patterns, plots, and some regression-style checks would be useful, but I do not want to force one specification too early.

I mostly want to know whether there is anything promising here, what the first-pass estimates look like, and what we would need to check before taking the result seriously.

Thanks,

The Hon. Dr. Sir Jensen Ahokovi, PhD, MA, BA.

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